

Daniel Forsthofer

Applied AI · Product & Delivery · GTM: I figure out what's worth building, build it, and take it to market, bridging tech and people to achieve **sustained measured ROI**.

The process turns conversations into working systems that simplify tasks and generate daily value. I've spent my career in the space between what people need and what technology can actually do, translating between the two. Every milestone has sharpened that skill. Communication is therefore central to everything I do.

TSplus: Head, Northern Europe · 2024–present

A French software multinational, where I expand the business among system administrators across Northern Europe. I've grown direct sales by **more than 80% (2025→26 YTD)** without a local team. When sales tools couldn't do what I needed, I built my own AI-powered outreach engine: it **scores prospects, does extensive research, and writes communication tailored to each country I'm working in**. It has also **replaced the SaaS subscription we were paying for**. GDPR compliance has been a major focus: the sensitive processing runs on local models on my self-hosted NVIDIA DGX Spark, air-gapped from the cloud, with Claude (or another frontier-level model) orchestrating but never touching personal data.

PPT Group: Senior Consultant & Delivery Manager · 2021–2023

A remote management consultancy where I ran custom product programmes end-to-end and closed the **biggest client contract the group had signed**. Across three flagship accounts:

- ▶ **Spur Group**: As Delivery Manager I took the team from waterfall to agile through a branded-app rollout that reached **2.5m+ customers**, standing up a **10-person agile internal org (5 product owners, 5 developers)** and a single Jira→Azure DevOps flow that bridged the marketing and development teams.
- ▶ **OPUS4business**: I **owned the relationship** for this field-service platform and rolled it out across a **mining group with 20+ sites around Southern Africa** (SOPs, health & safety and operations digitised), then delivered a **nationwide solar-installation build, later white-labelled** for partners. My customer, Probe Group, is one of SA's top three battery and solar providers.
- ▶ **Famous Brands (SA's largest food-franchise group, 3,000 restaurants, 20 brands)**: I turned SOPs into a dynamic digital-asset base, then **ran all change management**: 50+ online webinars and in-person roadshow workshops in Nelspruit, Cape Town and Johannesburg, 150+ participants at each session.

Tutto Consulting Services: Director of Operations · 2020–present

Most organisations' real processes live in people's heads. I get them out through structured workshops and into systems that have practical uses, with measurable ROI. Every implementation is phased: 1. Discovery & Ideation; 2. Build & Refine; 3. Change Management. A few I'm proud of:

- ▶ **RGBC**, one of the largest alcohol distributors in the Southern Hemisphere: I've brought AI into their design, HR and data teams — automated digital-asset generation, a CV-screening pipeline that handles **thousands of applicants**, and a rebuild of a departed analyst's entire reporting process in Claude. The systems are **in daily use** and save the teams a combined **12 hours a week** (minimum). I have recently secured another year's project extension for **2026–2027**, expanding into more work streams and bringing training into new parts of the organisation.
- ▶ **Pythia**, a **privacy-first legal AI** for a barrister who can't put confidential work anywhere near a cloud model: I set up an NVIDIA DGX Spark from scratch so the sensitive processing runs on local models, with Claude only ever orchestrating. I use the same architecture for full **GDPR compliance** with my outreach system at TSplus. Air-gapped for maximum security.
- ▶ **ABI** (the Association of British Investigators): I built their case-management system and a way for two investigators to discover they're chasing the same lead without either of them revealing a thing. Full tokenised encryption. I've been invited to give twice-yearly talks in Cambridge and London to the organisation's **400 members**, on this work and the current state of AI.

Tutto Food Co.: Managing Director · 2012–present

This one started as a weekend passion project: my wife and me cooking paella. It grew into **South Africa's largest paella-centric caterer**, at its peak turning over **around R4m** with **30 staff** cooking for **a thousand people a day**. I ran the whole thing on a system I built myself, down to an event-management and accounting package that **replaced Sage** (my auditor signed off on it). Fourteen years on, I still run it remotely from France: one manager on the ground, me handling clients, suppliers, finance and ops. Not what you may have expected on this CV ;)

HFI: Business Development & Account Executive · 2011–2012

I set up HFI's South African office from nothing: I flew to Mumbai and pitched them on opening in SA. I then built it: from one client to **three anchor accounts** (Standard Bank as the key account, plus Bidorbuy and CSIR), and grew a local team **from 0 to 5** before I left. I organised and facilitated 24+ public UX courses across Johannesburg, Pretoria and Cape Town, ~30 people per course: ~700 practitioners trained, including a good share of SA's top UX talent.

Standard Bank: New Territories & Products (Analyst) · 2010–2011

Part of the team building bottom-of-the-pyramid mobile banking for the African continent, working with groups in Nigeria, Uganda and Zambia: the work that became a **precursor to TymeBank**.

Education

Postgraduate Diploma in Management (Wits, **top 5 in my year**) · Honours in Philosophy (Wits) · BA Philosophy & Economics (Wits) · Matric, Head of Technology (Redhill High School)



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Born 1985.06.20

Citizenship: RSA & EU (Austria)

Residence: France

Languages (/+++++)

English	+++++
French	++
German	++
Afrikaans	++
Spanish	+

Skills & keywords

AI & data

AI Adoption & Enablement · Claude Code · Agentic Coding · MCP · RAG Systems · On-Prem & Local LLMs · LLM Fine-Tuning · Prompt Engineering · AI Strategy · BI & Dashboards · SharePoint · Power Automate · Azure DevOps

Delivery & product

Product Management · Product Ownership · Agile Delivery · SCRUM · Business Analysis · Process Mapping · DevOps · Leadership · Change Management · Programme Management · Jira

Business & leadership

Team Leadership · Delegation & Mentoring · Training & Enablement · Stakeholder Management · Executive Communication · Business Development · Operations Management · Management Accounting · P&L Ownership · UX / CX Design Thinking

Characteristics

Confident, Pragmatic, Resourceful, Articulate, Persuasive, Curious, Versatile, Creative, Socratic, Strategic, Dynamic, Driven.

Myers-Briggs: ENTP ·

Enneagram: Type 8

Interests: Immersive education, AI & agentic systems, nature & outdoors, DIY & home improvement, design, philosophy, behavioural science & Lego. Preference for aligning family, kids and dogs with my interests.